

Toddler Nighttime Resentment — Action Checklist

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OPTIMIZE THE BEDROOM ENVIRONMENT

- ☐ **Purchase a room thermometer and set the bedroom temperature to 68-72°F (20-22°C) because toddlers experience fragmented sleep when rooms are warmer than 74°F and their bodies struggle to stay warm below 65°F.:** Purchase a room thermometer and set the bedroom temperature to 68-72°F (20-22°C) because toddlers experience fragmented sleep when rooms are warmer than 74°F and their bodies struggle to stay warm below 65°F.
- ☐ **Install blackout curtains or use blackout shades to eliminate all light from the room since even small amounts of light from hallway nightlights or streetlights can fragment your toddler's sleep cycles throughout the night.:** Install blackout curtains or use blackout shades to eliminate all light from the room since even small amounts of light from hallway nightlights or streetlights can fragment your toddler's sleep cycles throughout the night.
- ☐ **Run white noise at 50-65 decibels continuously throughout the night to mask sudden household sounds that would otherwise wake your light-sleeping toddler, using a fan, app, or dedicated white noise machine.:** Run white noise at 50-65 decibels continuously throughout the night to mask sudden household sounds that would otherwise wake your light-sleeping toddler, using a fan, app, or dedicated white noise machine.
- ☐ **Move your toddler's crib or bed to a separate room from parents and siblings because shared sleep spaces cause toddlers to wake frequently from each other's sounds, movements, and breathing patterns.:** Move your toddler's crib or bed to a separate room from parents and siblings because shared sleep spaces cause toddlers to wake frequently from each other's sounds, movements, and breathing patterns.

CALCULATE THE RIGHT BEDTIME

- ☐ **Track the exact time your toddler's last nap ends and add 5 to 6 hours to find their natural bedtime window, which typically falls between 7pm and 8pm for most toddlers aged 18 months to 3.5 years.:** Track the exact time your toddler's last nap ends and add 5 to 6 hours to find their natural bedtime window, which typically falls between 7pm and 8pm for most toddlers aged 18 months to 3.5 years.

- **Keep bedtime consistent at the same clock time every night rather than moving it earlier when your toddler fights sleep, because overtiredness causes cortisol release that makes falling asleep physically harder.:** Keep bedtime consistent at the same clock time every night rather than moving it earlier when your toddler fights sleep, because overtiredness causes cortisol release that makes falling asleep physically harder.

- **If your calculated bedtime window falls at 9pm or later after adding 5-6 hours of wake time to the nap end, your toddler may be ready to drop to a single midday nap.:** If your calculated bedtime window falls at 9pm or later after adding 5-6 hours of wake time to the nap end, your toddler may be ready to drop to a single midday nap.

- **Begin the bedtime routine at least 2 hours before sleep time with quiet activities like reading, soft songs, or gentle puzzle play to gradually lower your toddler's arousal level before you start the official routine.:** Begin the bedtime routine at least 2 hours before sleep time with quiet activities like reading, soft songs, or gentle puzzle play to gradually lower your toddler's arousal level before you start the official routine.

BUILD THE EVENING WIND-DOWN

- **Remove all screens from the evening entirely since any screen time within 2 hours of bed worsens sleep by suppressing melatonin and keeping your toddler's brain in an alert state.:** Remove all screens from the evening entirely since any screen time within 2 hours of bed worsens sleep by suppressing melatonin and keeping your toddler's brain in an alert state.

 - **Avoid roughhousing, exciting new toys, sugar, and high-glycemic snacks during the final 2 hours before bed because these activities and foods trigger cortisol release that fights against sleepiness.:** Avoid roughhousing, exciting new toys, sugar, and high-glycemic snacks during the final 2 hours before bed because these activities and foods trigger cortisol release that fights against sleepiness.

 - **End bath time at least 90 minutes before your toddler's targeted bedtime because warm water temporarily raises body temperature and interferes with the natural temperature drop that helps trigger sleep onset.:** End bath time at least 90 minutes before your toddler's targeted bedtime because warm water temporarily raises body temperature and interferes with the natural temperature drop that helps trigger sleep onset.
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- ☐ **Include calming activities in your final wind-down such as reading together, singing soft lullabies, or nursing/bottle feeding in a dimly lit room to gently guide your toddler toward sleep readiness.:** Include calming activities in your final wind-down such as reading together, singing soft lullabies, or nursing/bottle feeding in a dimly lit room to gently guide your toddler toward sleep readiness.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.